

Deep-draft bulk berths at Paradip Port on India's east coast handle critical industrial cargo for steel, power and manufacturing clusters.

That network is becoming an increasingly important part of the company's growth strategy. The objective is not simply to operate individual ports, but to connect different points of the cargo journey and offer customers an integrated route from origin to destination.

The expansion also advances APSEZ's target of reaching 1 billion tonnes of cargo throughput by FY31. The company enters this next phase with 653 MMT of existing annual capacity and a portfolio spanning India's west, south and east coasts, supported by integrated logistics capabilities.

Paradip adds depth to the eastern leg of that network. Its location gives APSEZ another access point to the mineral and industrial base of eastern and central India, where steel, power, mining and manufacturing generate substantial cargo volumes.

The broader significance is also tied to the changing shape of India's economy. As manufacturing capacity expands and supply chains become more integrated, the ability to move raw materials reliably and efficiently becomes increasingly important. Ports are no longer just points where cargo is loaded and unloaded. Their value increasingly depends on how effectively they connect industrial centres with domestic and international markets.

Paradip is well placed in that equation. Its position on the East Coast and proximity to major mineral-producing and industrial regions give it a natural role in the movement of bulk commodities. For APSEZ, bringing that gateway into its network strengthens the company's ability to serve those flows while linking them to its wider port and logistics infrastructure.

There is also a geographical advantage. APSEZ's presence across the western, southern and eastern coasts gives it a broad operating footprint, while its logistics network can connect these gateways with inland markets. Paradip strengthens that national network without simply duplicating an existing coastal presence.

The concession therefore represents both a capacity addition and a network expansion. It gives APSEZ another strategic location from which to serve cargo-generating regions and strengthens the company's position in one of India's most important industrial corridors.

The Paradip win is not simply another addition to APSEZ's portfolio. It strengthens the company's East Coast footprint, deepens access to major cargo-generating regions and adds another piece to the integrated network it is building across India.

At a time when India's infrastructure needs are increasingly being shaped by industrial expansion, the importance of such connectivity is likely to grow. Paradip gives APSEZ a stronger position in that evolving trade and logistics landscape, while adding another link between the country's industrial heartland and its maritime gateways.

SCALE BEHIND THE EXPANSION

APSEZ has reached a new high in cargo handling, recording its highest-ever monthly cargo volume of 50 million metric tonnes (MMT) in August 2026, up 19 per cent year-on-year. The milestone reflects strong performance across its nationwide and international port network and comes as the company continues to broaden its cargo mix and deepen its presence across key trade corridors.

August growth was led by dry cargo, which rose 25 per cent year-on-year, and containers, which increased 15 per cent. The rapid growth of APSEZ's transshipment platforms at Vizhinjam and Colombo continues to strengthen its role in regional trade flows, while the company is also expanding its presence in liquid and coastal cargo.

Year-to-date August 2026, APSEZ handled 234.4 MMT of cargo, up 16 per cent year-on-year, led by dry cargo growth of 17 per cent and container growth of 15 per cent. Logistics rail volumes stood at 54,131 twenty-foot equivalent units (TEUs) in August, a sequential increase of 6 per cent. Year-to-date rail volumes stood at 250,461 TEUs.

The record monthly performance adds scale to APSEZ's broader growth trajectory and supports its ambition of handling 1 billion tonnes of annual cargo by FY31.



Infrastructure at Mundra Port in Gujarat, India's largest commercial port, where a new dedicated Empty Container Yard aims to streamline container movement and improve cargo turnaround.